

ACRYLATE

_____Name

_____Date

also called... many related names, such as ethyl acrylate, methyl methacrylate, and 2-hydroxyethyl methacrylate.

What is it?

Acrylates are used to make strong glues or to mold into plasticized shapes. Acrylates are produced from a chemical monomer that is a powder, liquid, gel, or paste. This monomer combines and hardens during a process called polymerization or curing. It is the *monomer* that can sensitize. Some sensitizer may remain after self-cured acrylates harden, but it is less likely to be present after ultraviolet-, anaerobic-, or heat-curing.

Where might it be found?

Adhesive tape (non-rubber)
Adhesives, sealers, stoppers
Artificial eye lens implants
Artificial fingernails
Bone cement for orthopedic use
Conducting gel for diathermy
Contact lenses, soft
Dental composite fillings
Dental temporary crowns, veneers
Dentures, dental prostheses
Electron microscopy material
Exfoliating cleansers
Eyeglasses
Feminine hygiene pads
Floppy disk, hard disk manufacture
Fragrance base
Gel electrophoresis
Hair sprays
Hearing aids
Incontinency pads
Industrial adhesives, epoxies
Insecticide
Insulin pumps
Leather finish resins
Light-curing gels
Microporous biomaterials
Mineral sedimentation
Nail polish, extender, hardener
Oil additive
Paint plasticizer
Paper coating
Plastic foam, coatings, Plexiglas
Printing inks, printing plates

Rubber coatings
Soil improver
Solvents
Splints
Television manufacture
Textile coatings and sizings
Ultraviolet cured glues, inks, paint
Water purification
Wig fixing adhesive
Windshield repair
Wood lacquer
Wound spray dressing

How to avoid it:

Acrylic monomer penetrates rubber gloves within 60 seconds. Two pairs of Neoprene or polyvinyl alcohol gloves may protect for a few minutes. For several hours' protection, wear Silver Shield/4H plastic polymer gloves (www.allerderm.com, 800-365-6868 or www.northsafety.com, 800-430-4110), Barrier Chemical Resistant Gloves (www.ansellpro.com, 800-800-0444), or polyvinyl alcohol gloves (www.grainger.com or www.airgas.com). Dentists may use zinc phosphate or zinc oxide cement to avoid acrylates. Acrylate dentures can be boiled in the mold to reduce allergens. Or substitute prostheses made of thermoplastic nylon, enterephthalate, or polyurethane. Substitute hearing aids made of silicone or polyamide nylon. Instead of acrylic fingernails, use preformed plastic nails or silk wrap with cyanoacrylate glue if you test negative to it.

****Tell your dentist and manicurist about this allergy.****